



Social Science Part 1 — Cbse Half-Yearly Exam — 80 Marks

Subject: Social Science Part 1 | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 20 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	Who prepares the Economic Survey of India? (A) The Reserve Bank of India (B) The Planning Commission (C) The Parliament directly (D) The Ministry of Finance <i>[Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]</i>	1
2	What is the primary focus of Social Science as a field of study? (A) The systematic study of human society and the intricate patterns of human interactions (B) The systematic study of the natural world and physical phenomena (C) The study of only past events and historical timelines (D) The study of only economic activities and resource distribution <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
3	The chapter states that Indian political thought adopted a holistic approach linking politics with multiple domains. Which of the following correctly lists these domains? (A) Geography, history, literature, and art (B) Economics, social life, morality, and defence (C) Physics, chemistry, biology, and mathematics (D) Numismatics, epigraphy, archaeology, and genealogy <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	What is the key difference between weathering and erosion? (A) Weathering involves movement of material; erosion does not (B) Both involve movement of material (C) Neither involves movement of material (D) Erosion involves movement of material; weathering does not <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
5	In which year did the Akkadian city-state emerge, overshadowing Sumerian power? (A) 3000 BCE (B) 2334 BCE (C) 2500 BCE (D) 2154 BCE <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1
6	Which type of democracy is practised in Switzerland? (A) Presidential Democracy (B) Representative Democracy (C) Parliamentary Democracy (D) Direct Democracy <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	1
7	India's multi-party system is said to reflect which of the following? (A) The country's rich diversity of languages, cultures, religions, and regions (B) The country's federal structure and separation of powers (C) The country's colonial history and administrative divisions (D) The country's economic policies and development priorities <i>[Ch 7: Elections]</i>	1
8	During which period did humans begin using microlithic tools and occupying temporary settlements near rivers and lakes? (A) Mesolithic period (B) Palaeolithic period (C) Neolithic period (D) Chalcolithic period <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
9	The Arthaśhāstra examined which of the following subjects, demonstrating that systematic thinking about governance and the economy existed long before modern academic disciplines developed? (A) The five great elements and their influence on human settlement patterns (B) The interconnectedness of human societies across regions and cultures (C) Administration, economic management, taxation, and the duties of rulers toward their people (D) The evolution of villages into towns and towns into cities <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
10	What is the purpose of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) conducted by the ECI? (A) To conduct exit polls after elections (B) To allocate election symbols to political parties (C) To update, verify, and correct the electoral rolls ensuring no eligible citizen is left out and no ineligible person is included (D) To decide the schedule and dates for elections <i>[Ch 7: Elections]</i>	1
11	Parabolic dunes differ from barchan dunes in which of the following ways? (A) Parabolic dunes are crescent-shaped; barchan dunes are U-shaped (B) Parabolic dunes have multiple arms; barchan dunes are long ridges parallel to wind (C) Parabolic dunes are U-shaped and often stabilised by vegetation; barchan dunes are crescent-shaped (D) Parabolic dunes form with multiple wind directions; barchan dunes form with a single wind direction <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
12	Which of the following pairs represents complementary goods? (A) Cars and petrol (B) Tea and coffee (C) Mangoes and bananas (D) Oranges and mangoes <i>[Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]</i>	1
13	Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a way Aśhoka's edicts promoted dhamma? (A) Strict enforcement of varṇa rules (B) Moral conduct (C) Respect within the family (D) Non-violence and compassion <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
14	What is the average height of the troposphere? (A) About 50 kilometres (B) About 5 kilometres (C) About 12 kilometres (D) About 100 kilometres <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	1
15	A garment manufacturer finds that machines are expensive and labour is cheap and easily available. Which production method is the firm most likely to prefer? (A) Capital-intensive production using more machines (B) Labour-intensive production using more workers (C) A complete shutdown of production until machines become affordable (D) Outsourcing all production to another country <i>[Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]</i>	1
16	Which type of weathering occurs when minerals in rocks change due to reactions with water, air, or acids? (A) Physical weathering (B) Biological weathering (C) Mechanical weathering (D) Chemical weathering <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
17	In the neighbourhood park example, why might the park never get built even though everyone needs it? (A) Because private companies would build it more efficiently (B) Because the government does not allow public parks in residential areas (C) Because many families think others will pay and they can use it without paying (D) Because the cost of land is too high for any single family <i>[Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]</i>	1
18	The word 'dharma' is derived from which Sanskrit root? (A) Dhri (B) Sat (C) Rit (D) Sam <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
19	Which Article of the Indian Constitution provides for amendments to ensure it remains flexible and responsive? (A) Article 32 (B) Article 14 (C) Article 19 (D) Article 368 <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	1
20	Under the National Monsoon Mission (NMM), which ministry developed state-of-the-art weather and climate prediction models? (A) Ministry of Agriculture (B) Ministry of Environment and Forests (C) Ministry of Science and Technology (D) Ministry of Earth Sciences <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	1
Section B Attempt 5 out of 7.		
21	How do political parties help ensure that democracy functions effectively? Mention any two ways. <i>[Ch 7: Elections]</i>	2
	OR Describe any three key characteristics of the troposphere. <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	
22	What was the Egyptian belief regarding 'ka' and how did it lead to the construction of pyramids? <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	2
	OR Distinguish between stalactites and stalagmites based on their formation and position in caves. <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	
23	Which Buddhist text describes the eight stages of agricultural operations, and what does this indicate about farming practices in the post-Mauryan period? <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	2
24	What is the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and what role does it play in preserving cultural memory? <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	2
25	Why is media referred to as the 'fourth pillar of democracy'?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	
Section C Attempt 5 out of 7.		
26	How are waterfalls formed, and what significance do they hold for human activities? <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	3
	OR Describe the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and its significance in preserving cultural memory in Bharat. <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	
27	What was the Code of Hammurabi, and why was it significant for future legal systems? <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	3
	OR What is participatory democracy, and how does it differ from merely holding periodic elections? <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	
28	Why are periodic elections considered a crucial element of democracy? Explain with reference to accountability of elected representatives. <i>[Ch 7: Elections]</i>	3
29	Compare and contrast the land breeze and the sea breeze, explaining the mechanisms behind each. <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	3
30	What does the Rig Veda verse (9.112.3) reveal about occupational diversity in early Vedic society, and how does it challenge the idea of fixed hereditary occupations? <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	3
Section D Attempt 4 out of 6.		
31	Democracy does not offer a single model of government, and different societies institutionalise democracy in diverse ways. Compare and contrast the different types of democracy and systems of government, explaining how they are practised in India, Canada, the United Kingdom, and the United States of America. <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	5
	OR Describe the composition of the atmosphere and explain how the atmosphere regulates conditions on Earth, influencing weather and climate. Support your answer with relevant examples from the elements of weather discussed.	



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	<i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	
32	Discuss how the River Nile shaped the growth of Egyptian civilisation, and explain how the Egyptians' understanding of their environment influenced their calendar, governance, and religious practices including mummification and pyramid construction. <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	5
	OR Weathering and erosion are continuous processes that reshape the Earth's surface. Explain the different types of weathering and erosion, and analyze how erosion impacts various human occupations and livelihoods. <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	
33	Why should we study Social Science? Discuss how it helps us understand the systems around us, appreciate diversity, participate in democratic life, and connect the past, present, and future. <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	5
34	Trace the evolution of political organisation in the Indian subcontinent from the early Vedic period to the rise of mahājanapadas. How did the transition from kinship-based identity to territorial identity shape administrative systems? <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	5
Section E Attempt 3 out of 4.		
35	Case Study: Wind Erosion and Desert Landforms In arid regions, strong winds pick up and carry away loose particles of sand and soil, gradually shaping the landscape through wind erosion. This process creates several distinctive landforms. Yardangs are streamlined rock ridges carved by wind, while ventifacts are rocks polished and shaped by sandblasting. Deflation hollows or blowouts are shallow depressions formed where loose material is removed, and desert pavements are flat surfaces left behind after finer particles are blown away. Dunes are hills or ridges of sand formed by wind in desert areas or along sandy coasts. Barchan dunes are crescent-shaped and form in areas with limited sand and a single wind direction, while star dunes have multiple arms and form where winds come from different directions. (i) What are yardangs and how are they formed? (ii) Distinguish between deflation hollows and desert pavements. (iii) Compare barchan dunes and star dunes in terms of their shape and the wind conditions under which they form. (iv) How do dunes serve as natural barriers for humans in coastal regions? <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Case Study: Understanding Society Through a Village's Daily Life A village in India is situated near a long coastline that historically facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia. The villagers depend on farming, while some engage in trade. The local Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in local development planning, reflecting grassroots democracy. Roads are maintained by public authorities, and electricity arrives from distant power stations through a vast network. The food villagers eat has been harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Social Science helps explain why agriculture flourishes here, how governments make decisions affecting millions, and how environments influence life. Society does not function by chance—it is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. (i) Define Social Science in simple words. (ii) How does the Panchayati Raj system embody grassroots democracy in India's villages? (iii) Explain how the village's daily life demonstrates the interconnection of multiple Social Science disciplines. Refer to at least two disciplines. (iv) Why does the passage state that 'society does not function by chance'? What factors shape it? <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	
36	Case Study: Early Human Ancestors and Stone Tools Around 3.3 million years ago, one of our earliest ancestors made the first stone tools, marking the beginning of 'human behaviour'. These ancestors came to be known as 'hominins' or tool makers. The tools they created functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people perform tasks they could not accomplish with their hands alone. Homo habilis, the 'handy man', lived in Africa around 2–6 million years ago and made chopper stone tools. Their successors, Homo erectus, invented handaxes and cleavers and were among the first to migrate out of Africa, spreading into Europe and Asia. While all human ancestors were tool makers, it was Homo sapiens who developed complex technologies, including the bow and arrow, microblade tools, and symbolic communication through cave paintings and beads. (i) Why are early humans referred to as 'hominins'? (ii) What is meant by the term 'extra-corporal limbs' in the context of stone tools? (iii) Compare the contributions of Homo habilis and Homo erectus to early human technology. How did Homo sapiens further advance upon these developments? (iv) Why is the making of stone tools considered the beginning of 'human behaviour' rather than animal behaviour? <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	5



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37	Case Study: Atmospheric Pressure, Wind, and Local Breezes Atmospheric pressure is the pressure exerted by the weight of air on the Earth's surface. It is highest at sea level and decreases with altitude. Horizontally, air pressure distribution is influenced by temperature. In high-temperature areas, air heats up and rises, creating low-pressure areas associated with cloudy skies and wet weather. In lower-temperature areas, cold air sinks, creating high-pressure areas associated with clear and sunny skies. Air always moves from high-pressure to low-pressure areas, and this movement is called wind. Local winds like the sea breeze and land breeze affect coastal climates. During the day, land warms faster than sea, creating a low-pressure region over land, causing wind to blow from sea to land. At night, land cools faster than sea, and wind blows from land to sea. (i) What is atmospheric pressure and how does it change with altitude? (ii) How does temperature influence the creation of high-pressure and low-pressure areas? (iii) Explain the mechanism of sea breeze and land breeze, and how they create moderate climatic conditions in coastal regions. (iv) Why is a low-pressure area associated with cloudy skies and wet weather while a high-pressure area is associated with clear and sunny skies? <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	5

